PINPOINT DELIVERY

Direct benefit transfer has reduced fraud and improved the efficiency of the welfare delivery mechanism, ensuring the needy get timely benefits

By SONAL KHETARPAL



SEEDS OF GROWTH
Farmer Ram Lal and wife Bala Devi, beneficiaries of Kisan Samman Nidhi, Jaisinghpura village, Jaipur

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

THE DRUDGERY

Availing government welfare scheme benefits was an ordeal, with rent-seeking at multiple stages—application, approval and distribution. Beneficiaries received shares as low as 30 per cent of the due amount while the rest was siphoned off as cuts by government officials. The welfare ecosystem was also marred by issues such as fund diversions, duplicate payments, complex sanctions, fraudulent claimants accessing benefits and the exclusion of deserving individuals. Not to mention the endless trips to government offices, collating numerous documents, securing multiple sanctions and greasing the palms of many individuals encountered along the way.

DIRECT BENEFIT TRANSFER (DBT)
Launched on Jan. 1, 2013

Achievement:
Rs 2.14 lakh cr. disbursed through 1,016 schemes to 1,040 mn beneficiaries by Nov. '23